

General Education Reflection

Classes: Music 1010, Music 1020, ComST 2100, Music 3040

Over my time at Iowa State University, I have had the opportunity to take several general education classes. While many were music majors – as I was pursuing a music minor – I had taken ComST 2100, Communication and U.S. Diversity. This course was interesting, as it brought up many issues I had not thought of before. These issues are often discussed as workplace issues I would never have experienced myself, like workplace discrimination. This will apply directly to me, as I will work in an office environment as an engineer, and it will be important to ensure I can maintain an inclusive environment. This class also taught softer communication skills that will be invaluable when working in the engineering industry, where communication standards are high.

I took several music classes, from an introduction to music theory (Music 1010) to the history of American rock and roll (Music 3040). These music classes were by far the most enjoyable non-engineering courses I had taken. While not technically challenging, it helped me develop a deeper appreciation for the arts. Music today is rapidly changing, with new tastes and genres developing faster by the day. As a result, new tools have been created, such as AI-generated content. This new technology will have lasting impacts, both positive and negative. These courses have helped me realize that there are many problems that, while artistic, actually involve a lot of science and approaches to “solve” or create new content.